Participant Copy

Write your name on this copy. Keep this notebook for the whole program.

2026 Clinical Research Training Institute in Latin America

American Society of Hematology
Grand Hyatt Bogotá
Bogotá, Colombia
May 4-6, 2026

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About

The ASH Clinical Research Training Institute (CRTI) in Latin America is a two-day highly-interactive in-person workshop intended for fellows and early- to mid-career hematology faculty working in Latin American countries to become more familiar with clinical trial design and execution. As a participant, you will:

- Build a foundation and explore the methodologies of patient-oriented clinical research.
- Strengthen fundamental skills needed to become a successful patient-oriented clinical leader.
- Gain extensive networking opportunities with others who share the same passion.
- Develop a potential capstone project that builds upon skills learned during the curriculum and small group peer-reviews.
- Receive individualized mentorship from program faculty to advance your proposed project.

This program is made possible by the positive evaluation responses received over the last two decades. Evaluation data drives progress and expansion of ASH's ability to reach audiences around the world.

Be attentive and on-time to sessions

Abide by the Confidentiality Agreement

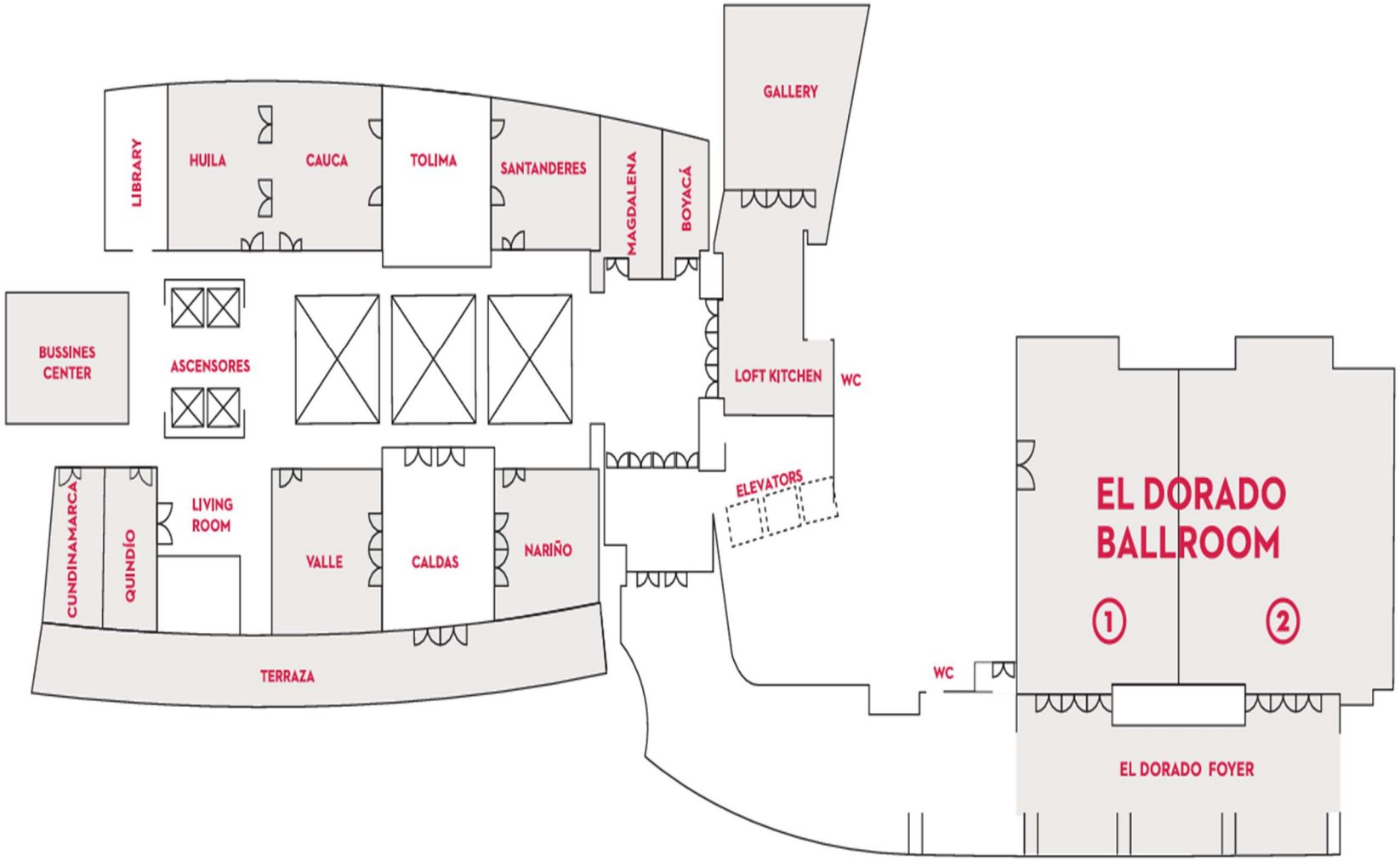
Engage with the programming by contributing your thoughts

Limit distractions

Provide timely feedback by completing surveys on-time

Map

Level 2 of the Grand Hyatt



CRTI-LA Curriculum & Schedule

MONDAY, MAY 4, 2026

18:30 – 19:30	**Joint Reception with Poster Presentations** Location: El Dorado Foyer
19:30 – 21:30	**Joint Dinner with Blood Global Hematology Opportunity & Career Retrospective** Location: El Dorado 2 *Dr. Wellington Silva*

TUESDAY, MAY 5, 2026 | EL DORADO 1

7:00 – 7:50	**Breakfast Available in the Hotel**	
08:00 – 08:30	**Welcoming Remarks** *Drs. Cece Calhoun & Roberta Demichelis*	
08:30 – 09:15	**Clinical Research Question** *Drs. Lucia Perez Bailero & Kara Kelly*	
09:15 – 10:00	**Importance of Good Mentorship** *Drs. Allison King & Cristobal Frutos*	
10:00 – 10:15	**Break** Location: El Dorado 1 Foyer	
10:15 – 11:15	**Clinical Research Study Design** *Drs. Humberto Martinez & Eloisa Riva*	
11:15 – 12:00	**Conflicts of Interest & Maintaining Ethics** *Drs. Andrés Gómez De León & Kara Kelly*	
12:00 – 13:00	**Lunch with Career Conversations** Location: Terraza Capitalino Participants will choose their preferred topic to participate in during this lunch session.	
13:00 – 14:15	**Searching the Literature & How to Use Bibliographic Software** *Elizabeth Uleryk*	
14:15 – 14:45	**Presentation Tips** *Dr. Roberta Demichelis*	
14:45 – 15:00	**Break** Location: El Dorado 1 Foyer	
15:00 – 17:30	**Small Groups Breakouts** • Participant Presentations: Each participant has 10 minutes to present and 2 minutes for questions. • Refine the research question & statistical plan Participants should ask each other questions about their fellow member's projects.	Room Assignments: • Small Group 1 - Nariño • Small Group 2 - Caldas • Small Group 3 - Valle • Small Group 4 - Cauca • Small Group 5 - Tolima
18:30 – 20:30	**Participants Choose Your Own Adventure** There are no ASH-planned dinners this evening. Your dinner may be reimbursed if you retain your receipt. A maximum of US$65 will be reimbursed for dinner. Instructions for reimbursement will be sent after the workshop. Participants are encouraged to dine together.	

WEDNESDAY, MAY 6, 2026 | EL DORADO 1

	Participants & Faculty Check Out of Hotel	
7:00 – 7:50	**Breakfast Available in the Hotel**	
07:55 – 8:00	**Morning Remarks** *Drs. Cece Calhoun & Roberta Demichelis*	
08:00 – 09:00	**How to Write an Abstract & Manuscript for Publication** *Drs. Fernanda Orsi & Robert Negrin*	
09:00 – 10:15	**Concurrent Programming** Half of the cohort will attend one workshop. The other half will attend the other workshop. After the break, the halves will switch.	
	Registry Session Location: Nariño *Drs. Jane Hankins & Lucia Perez Baliero*	**Biostatistics Session** Location: Caldas *Drs. Susan Geyer & Adrian Soto & Eliana Miranda*
10:15 – 10:30	**Break** Location: El Dorado 1 Foyer	
10:30 – 11:45	**Concurrent Programming (cont.)**	
11:45 – 12:45	**Lunch** Location: Terraza Capitalino	
12:45 – 14:45	**Small Group Breakouts** Agenda • Define outcomes • General procedures • Stats and sample size • Project plans (e.g. regulatory funding) and outcomes/impact • Career plans	Room Assignments: • Small Group 1 - Nariño • Small Group 2 - Caldas • Small Group 3 - Valle • Small Group 4 - Cauca • Small Group 5 - Tolima
14:45 – 15:00	**Break** Location: El Dorado 1 Foyer	
15:00 – 16:15	**One-on-One Mentoring** Location: El Dorado 2 Participants will meet with 3 faculty members for 20 minutes each (5 min transition period between sessions).	
16:15 – 17:00	**Turning Ideas into Impact: Building Clinical Research from the Ground Up in Latin America** *Drs. Eloisa Riva & Wellington Silva*	
17:00 – 17:10	**Closing Remarks** *Drs. Cece Calhoun & Roberta Demichelis*	
17:10 – 17:30	**Participants Complete Evaluations** Participants may go to any of the breakout rooms for this task, but must leave the El Dorado 1 room and El Dorado Foyer.	
17:30	**Adjourn**	

Program Leadership

Cece Calhoun
MD, MPHS, MBA
cece.calhoun@yale.edu

Yale University, School of Medicine
New Haven, CT, USA

Specialty: Sickle Cell Disease

Cecelia Calhoun, MD, MPHS, MBA, is an Assistant Professor of Medicine (Hematology) and (Hematology/Oncology) at Yale University School of Medicine where her clinical and research expertise center on the care of persons with Sickle Cell Disease (SCD) She also serves as the Medical Director of the Adult Sickle Cell Program at Smilow Cancer Hospital. Dr. Calhoun uses mixed methods to find solutions to the educational and healthcare obstacles critical to the longevity of adolescents with sickle cell disease. She has dedicated her career to the design and implementation of evidence-based interventions that promote successful transition from youth to adult care for the sickle cell population. As an NIH funded investigator, she collaborates with her hematology colleagues across the nation to use Implementation Science methods to improve outcomes for patients with sickle cell disease throughout their lifespans. Born in Detroit, Michigan, Dr. Calhoun graduated from the University of Michigan with a Bachelor of Arts degree in Afro-American Studies and Medical Doctorate from Wayne State University. She continued her training at Michigan State University as a pediatric resident, then fellowship at Washington University School of Medicine where she also completed a Master of Population Health Sciences. She received her MBA as one of three, inaugural Pozen-Commonwealth Fund Fellows in Minority Health Leadership at Yale University School of Management.

Roberta Demichelis
MD
robertademichelis@gmail.com

Instituto Nacional de Ciencias Médicas y Nutrición Salvador
Zubirán, México

Specialty: Leukemia

Dr. Demichelis is an assistant professor in the Department of Hematology/Oncology at the Instituto Nacional de Ciencias Médicas y Nutrición Salvador Zubirán (INCMNSZ) in Mexico City, Mexico. She is a clinician and clinical investigator with a focus on acute leukemia in adults. She completed her residency in Internal Medicine and fellowship in Hematology at the same Institution. She is the coordinator of the Acute Leukemia Clinic at INCMNSZ. She previously was the Coordinator of the Acute Leukemia Working Group of the Mexican National Hematology Society (Agrupación Mexicana para el Estudio de la Hematología, AMEH) and she is currently the coordinator of the scientific and academic activities of AMEH. Her primary clinical interests include diagnosis, genetics and treatment of acute leukemia in adults. She is particularly interested in working in collaborative groups to improve the outcomes in Latin America.

Faculty Roster

Lucas Bassoli
PhD
lbassolli@gmail.com

Center for Clinical Trials and Pharmacovigilance at Butantan Foundation
São Paulo, Brazil
Specialty: Biostatistician

Dr. Bassolli de Oliveira Alves earned his Ph.D. from the School of Medicine of the University of São Paulo. He is currently the Manager of Data Science at the Center for Clinical Trials and Pharmacovigilance at Butantan Foundation. Additionally, he collaborates on research projects at the Hematology and Cell Therapy Service of the Hospital das Clínicas of the University of São Paulo. As a data scientist in the health area, his work focuses on the acquisition, management, and analysis of biomedical research data as well as health technologies assessment. His background is in exploratory and inferential statistical analysis, data management, multivariate models, survival analysis, generalized linear models, unsupervised or partially supervised predictive research, health technology assessment, and data storytelling.

Cristóbal Frutos
MD
cfrutosortiz@gmail.com

Instituto de Prevision Social
Asunción, Paraguay
Specialty: Acute Leukemias | HCT

During my hematology residency in 2016, I took the initiative to apply for the American Society of Hematology (ASH) Clinical Research Training Institute (CRTI). To my surprise, I was accepted, and there I met my first major mentor, Dr. Joseph Mikhael. The CRTI experience profoundly shaped my commitment to applied clinical research and its real-world impact on patient care. Inspired by this training, I subsequently conducted a retrospective study of fit acute myeloid leukemia (AML) patients diagnosed and treated at the Instituto de Previsión Social, Paraguay's largest hematology service. The findings revealed an alarming survival gap among young AML patients and mobilized our entire hematology service to act, attracting national and international attention. This momentum ultimately led me to Germany in 2017 to train under Professor Dietger Niederwieser, where I observed more than 100 bone marrow transplants and prepared to advance transplantation in Paraguay. Over the past eight years, I have served as President of the first Paraguayan Bone Marrow Donor Association, President of the Latin American Bone Marrow Transplantation Society, and Coordinator of the Paraguayan BMT Program. Currently, I serve as BMT Unit Coordinator at the Instituto de Previsión Social and advisor to Paraguay's Vice Minister of Health.

Melina Garbarini
MD
Melina.garbarini@hospitalitaliano.org.ar

Hospital Italiano De Buenos Aires
Caba, Argentina
Specialty: Transplant/Hemostasis | Thrombosis/Outcomes

Melina Garbarini is a clinician specializing in critical care medicine and hematology. She obtained her medical degree from the University of Buenos Aires and completed her residency in critical care medicine in 2018 at the Italian Hospital of Buenos Aires, where she also served as Chief Resident in the Intensive Care Unit. Following her residency, she continued her career as an intensivist. Additionally, she pursued further specialization in hematology at the Instituto Universitario del Hospital Italiano. Currently, Melina is undertaking a fellowship in bone marrow transplantation at the Hospital Italiano. Over the past five years, she has worked as a staff physician in the hospital's intensive care unit. She is a member of the Critical Oncology Committee of the Argentine Society of Intensive Care and the Young Hematologist Committee of the Argentine Society of Hematology. Melina also serves as the Chief of Practical Work for the Advanced Course in Intensive Care Medicine at the Argentine Society of Intensive Care. Melina's research interests focus on the intersection of hematology and critical care medicine, particularly in the fields of hemostasis and oncologic hematological patients and their complications.

Susan Geyer | Mayo Clinic
PhD | Rochester, MN, USA
geyer.susan@mayo.edu | **Specialty**: Biostatistician

Dr. Geyer is senior biostatistical faculty at the Mayo Clinic in the Division of Clinical Trials and Biostatistics. She has over twenty years of experience in designing, monitoring, and analyzing clinical trials as well as observational and immunological studies as a statistical collaborator. Dr. Geyer has specific interest and focus in novel trial designs for targeted therapies and risk-directed allocation as well as studies in rare disease settings. She has worked with single cell immunomic data, and has applied her expertise in spatial statistics to develop new approaches for modeling these relationships. Dr. Geyer is the lead faculty statistician for Hematology at Mayo Clinic and is a co-Director of the Biostatistics and Bioinformatics Core for the Mayo Myeloma SPORE grant. She is currently the lead or co-lead faculty statistician for several disease committees in the Alliance cooperative group, including the Myeloma and the Lymphoma Committees. Dr. Geyer is also an elected member of several NCI Steering Committees, including Myeloma and Leukemia and has served as an ad hoc reviewer for the NCI Lymphoma Steering Committee. She was the Director of Biostatistics for the international clinical trials network in Type 1 Diabetes, TrialNet, and was the lead biostatistician on a large international programmatic contract funded by the NIAID and led by the Radiation Effects Research Foundation to study radiation and immunosenescence in atomic bomb survivors. Dr. Geyer has served as invited faculty for the American Society of Hematology Clinical Research Training Institute since 2006 and the Lymphoma Research Foundation Clinical Research Mentoring Program 2014-2023. Dr. Geyer has served as an invited member of the Scientific Program Committees for the American Society of Clinical Oncology and the American Association for Cancer Research, and has served on multiple grant review panels and working group committees through the NIH.

Andrés Gómez De León | University Hospital of Universidad Autónoma de Nuevo Leon
MD | Monterrey, NL, México
drgomezdeleon@gmail.com | **Specialty**: Leukemia | BMT

Dr. Andrés Gómez De León is Associate Professor of Hematology in the University Hospital of Universidad Autónoma de Nuevo Leon in the city of Monterrey, México. He leads the acute leukemia clinic and is a member of the bone marrow transplant team where he leads the telemedicine clinic. He is a CRTI-LA and CRTI alumnus and ASH Global Research Awardee. He has several roles international cell therapy societies like ASTCT and LABMT. His research interests include treatment and access optimization for persons living in low and middle income countries and disparities in research, as well as leading the first project for implementation of chimeric antigen receptor T cells in Mexico.

Jane Hankins | St Jude Children's Research Hospital
MD, MS | Memphis, TN, USA
jane.hankins@stjude.org | **Specialty**: Sickle Cell Disease | Outcomes

Dr. Jane Hankins is a member of the Department of Global Pediatric Medicine at St. Jude Children's Research Hospital and her institution's director of the Global Hematology Program. Dr. Hankins' research interests include applying implementation and dissemination science methods to improve the transition from pediatric to adult care process and to implement newborn screening programs for sickle cell disease in low and middle-income countries. Dr. Hankins has many years of experience running clinical trials for sickle cell disease. She implemented a lifetime cohort study to understand better the role of clinical and genetic predictive factors in the progression of sickle cell disease, SCCRIP.

Kara Kelly
MD
kara.kelly@roswellpark.org

Roswell Park Comprehensive Center
Buffalo, NY, USA

Specialty: Leukemia | Lymphoma | Pediatrics | Outcomes

Kara Kelly, MD is the Waldemar J. Kaminski Endowed Chair of Pediatrics at Roswell Park Comprehensive Center and Professor of Pediatrics at the University at Buffalo Jacobs School of Medicine and Biomedical Sciences where she is the chief of the pediatric hematology/oncology program. She specializes in the treatment of children with hematological malignancies, especially Hodgkin lymphoma. Her research focuses on clinical trials and correlative studies for childhood and adolescent Hodgkin lymphoma. Dr. Kelly is the Past Chair of the Children's Oncology Group (COG) Hodgkin lymphoma committee and has served as the national study chair for clinical trials of new treatment approaches for pediatric patients with advanced stage disease. She currently serves on the National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN) Pediatric Hodgkin lymphoma guidelines panel, Lymphoma Research Foundation Scientific Advisory Board, and the COG Hodgkin Lymphoma Steering Committee.

Allison King
MD, PhD, MPH
king_a@wustl.edu

Washington University
St. Louis, Missouri, USA

Specialty: Sickle Cell Disease | Outcomes

Dr. King is the Fred M. Saigh Distinguished Chair in Pediatric Research and Professor of Pediatrics, Medicine, and Public Health Sciences at Washington University and Medical Director of Survivorship at the Siteman Cancer Center. She is a pediatric and young adult hematologist and oncologist with formal training in clinical investigation, research methods in public health and education, and implementation science. She served as 2016-2018 Co-Director at North America CRTI after first attending as a trainee in 2005. She currently chairs the CRTI steering committee. Her clinical research is focused on the health and education of children and adults with chronic conditions like sickle cell disease and cancer. Her lab assesses the development, cognition and environment and tests interventions to improve the health and function of these populations. She uses implementation science methods to increase the uptake of evidence-based practices to improve outcomes. She also serves as Associate Director of the Center for Dissemination and Implementation and Lead for the Education and Training Initiatives at the Institute for Public Health at Washington University.

Humberto Martinez
MD, MSc
humbertomartinez48@hotmail.com

Jefe de la Unidad de Hematología y Trasplante de Médula Ósea,
Hospital Militar Central | Instituto Nacional de Cancerología (INC)
Bogotá, Colombia

Specialty: Leukemia | Lymphoma | Multiple Myeloma | Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation (autologous and allogeneic) | Cellular Therapy | Myeloma-related complications | Precision Medicine in hematologic malignancies

Dr. Humberto Martinez-Cordero is a board-certified hematologist with expertise in multiple myeloma, lymphoma, leukemia, and hematopoietic stem cell transplantation. He earned his MD from Universidad de Caldas, completed Internal Medicine and Hematology training at Universidad Nacional de Colombia, and holds an MSc in Epidemiology from Universidad El Bosque. He pursued advanced fellowship training in Multiple Myeloma and related diseases at the Princess Margaret Cancer Centre, University of Toronto.

Currently, he serves as Head of the Hematology and Bone Marrow Transplant Unit at Hospital Militar Central in Bogotá and is actively involved in clinical care and research at the Instituto Nacional de Cancerología. His work focuses on improving access to transplantation and novel therapies in Latin America, participating in collaborative groups such as GELAMM (Grupo Latinoamericano de Mieloma Múltiple) and international initiatives. Dr. Martinez-Cordero has authored numerous peer-reviewed publications on myeloma outcomes, disparities in Latin America, and transplant-related topics. He is passionate about education, serving as a professor in hematology/oncology programs, and advancing equity in hematologic cancer care across the region.

Eliana Miranda
PhD, MEd
elianam@g.unicamp.br

State University of Campinas (UNICAMP) and SBTMO
Campinas, São Paulo, Brazil

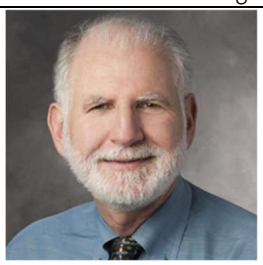
Specialty: Biostatistician

Dr. Miranda holds her PhD in the area of basic sciences (Biostatistics) of the Graduate course at the Medical Sciences Faculty (2013) and Master's degree in Education (MEd.) 2006 at UNICAMP. She has been involved in protocol design and development, providing data analysis, statistical reports, interpretation and explanation of research findings, as well as writing the statistical section for manuscripts. She mostly contributed to statistical analyzes with a focus on survival, competitive events, and bootstrap methods. Currently Eliana works as a Scientific Coordinator of Bone Marrow Transplant Brazilian Society (SBTMO) and T-cell Brazil Project. She is a member of Brazilian Board of Advisors of the Associazione Italo-Braziliana di Ematologia (AIBE), and member of the Grupo de Estudio Latinoamericano de Linfoproliferativos (GELL).

Robert Negrin
MD
negrs@stanford.edu

Stanford University
Stanford, CA, USA

Specialty: Transplant



Robert Negrin, MD is a professor of medicine and former Chief of the Division of Blood and Marrow Transplantation and Cellular Therapy at Stanford University. He received his undergraduate degree from the University of California at Berkeley and MD from Harvard Medical School. He trained in Internal Medicine and Hematology at Stanford University and joined the faculty at Stanford University in 1990. His research focuses on developing a more fundamental understanding of immune mediated reactions such as graft vs host and graft vs tumor reactions with a particular interest in immune regulatory mechanisms. Several concepts developed in his laboratory have been translated to clinical trials. Dr. Negrin has published over 300 manuscripts and 44 book chapters. He has won a number of awards including fellowships from the Damon Runyon Walter Winchell Cancer Fund and the Jose Carreras International Leukemia Foundation. He was a recipient of a Distinguished Clinical Science Award from the Doris Duke Foundation. He received the E. Donnall Thomas lectureship from ASTCT. He is an elected member of the Association of American Physicians. Dr. Negrin has served on multiple editorial boards and was an Associate Editor of Blood and the Founding Editor in Chief at Blood Advances. He has served as the President of the International Society of Cellular Therapy, the American Society of Blood and Marrow Transplantation (currently American Society of Transplantation and Cellular Therapy) and is the current President of the American Society of Hematology.

Fernanda Orsi
MD, PhD
fernanda.orsi@uol.com.br

UNICAMP
Campinas, São Paulo, Brazil

Specialty: Hemostasis | Thrombosis

Dr. Orsi is a medical doctor, graduated from the School of Medical Sciences of UNICAMP, where she completed the Residency in Haematology and Haemotherapy and both the Masters and PhD in Clinical Medicine. Fernanda also holds a PhD in Clinical Epidemiology from the LUMC. She is an Associate Professor at the Department of Pathology, Division of Clinical Pathology, School of Medical Sciences, UNICAMP. She is also a Visiting Professor at the Department of Clinical Epidemiology, Leiden University Medical Center (LUMC), the Netherlands. Throughout her research career, Fernanda has been active in the study of biomarkers and clinical aspects of thromboembolic and hemorrhagic diseases. She has been awarded various training, travel and reach the world grants from the American Society of Hematology and the International Society of Thrombosis and Hemostasis. Fernanda has also received research grants from the São Paulo Research Foundation (FAPESP) and the Brazilian National Council of Scientific and Technological Development (CNPq) to develop studies in the field of antiphospholipid syndrome and thrombosis. Fernanda is the Brazilian representative in the Latin American Cooperative Group of Hemostasis and Thrombosis (CLAHT). Her research focuses on the interaction between coagulation and inflammation/immunity in thrombosis and severe thrombotic diseases.

Lucía Pérez Baliero | Hospital De Clinicas
MD | Montevideo, Uruguay
Luciaperezbaliero@gmail.com | **Specialty**: Plasma Cell Disorders | Multiple Myeloma

Dr. Lucia Perez Baliero is a recently certified hematologist who completed her hematology training at the Hospital de Clínicas in Montevideo, Uruguay. During her training, she participated in several hematology research projects and is currently involved in a collaborative study with the MD Anderson Cancer Center. Her main interests focus on the study of hematologic neoplasms, particularly plasma cell disorders. In 2022, she was awarded the Young Investigator Award by the International Myeloma Group in Los Angeles, United States. She anticipates that the advanced CRTI-LA will offer valuable networking opportunities with leading experts and peers, encouraging potential collaborations and supporting her professional growth in clinical research. She is also particularly interested in engaging with local faculty and gaining insights from their experiences within the regional clinical research landscape.

Eloísa Riva | Hospital Británico
MD, MEd | Montevideo, Uruguay
eloisariva@gmail.com | **Specialty**: Myeloma

Dr. Riva, MD, MEd is an associate professor of hematology at the Hospital de Clínicas, Montevideo, Uruguay. She received her medical degree from Facultad de Medicina, Universidad de la República, Montevideo, Uruguay. She completed her residency in internal medicine, and her fellowship in hematology. From 2007 to 2013, she was assistant professor of Hematology at Hospital de Clínicas, and since 2013 she has been an Associate professor and head of the Myeloma Unit. Dr. Riva also serves as a hematologist at Hospital Británico, in Montevideo. Dr. Riva is highly involved in education and completed a master's degree in Education at Hospital Italiano, Buenos Aires. She is actively engaged in patient care, education, and mentorship. Her clinical research focuses are plasma cell disorders. She is a member of the International Myeloma Working Group, a member of the Board of Directors of the International Society of Amyloidosis, and of the Medical Educators Institute and the Committee on Training of ASH. She has been honored with scholarships at the Myeloma Unit in Salamanca, Spain under the mentorship of Dr. Jesús San Miguel, and the ASH Visitor Training Program at Centro di Amiloidosi, Pavía, Italia, under the mentorship of Dr. Giampaolo Merlini. Dr Riva is the President of the Grupo de Estudio Latinoamericano de Mieloma Múltiple (GELAMM). Since 2015 she has been Faculty at the Clinical Research Training Institute-Latin America (ASH).

Natalia Schütz | Instituto Universitario del Hospital Italiano de Buenos Aires (IUHI)
MD | Buenos Aires, Argentina
natalia.schutz@hospitalitaliano.org.ar | **Specialty**: Myeloma

Dr. Schütz is an assistant professor in the Department of Internal Medicine at the Instituto Universitario del Hospital Italiano de Buenos Aires (IUHI) in Argentina. She is a clinician and clinical investigator with a focus on multiple myeloma and lymphoproliferative diseases.

She completed her medical degree at Universidad Favaloro and a postgraduate degree in Internal Medicine and Hematology at the Universidad de Buenos Aires in Argentina. She received her master's degree from the CNIO in Spain and a master's degree in clinical research from the Instituto Universitario del Hospital Italiano de Buenos Aires. Dr.Schütz completed her residency at the Hospital Italiano de Buenos Aires and a fellowship in hematology and bone marrow transplantation at FUNDALEU. After completing her training, she joined the faculty at the Hospital Italiano de Buenos Aires and currently serves as attending physician and senior researcher in the Hematology Division. She is also the director of the fellowship program in Hematology at her center. As a young researcher, Dr Schütz participated in the ASH Clinical Research and Training Institute for Latin America and is now in her fifth year as faculty as faculty. Dr. Schützes research interests are in multiple myeloma and malignant hematology. She served for several years on the Research Council at the Hospital Italiano de Buenos Aires and the Scientific and Research Committee of the Argentinean Society of Hematology. Currently, Dr. Schutz is working on several research projects with the Argentinean and Latin American Myeloma Study Group (GAMM and GELAMM) and the International Myeloma Foundation (IMF).

Wellington Silva
MD, PhD
wellington.jr001@yahoo.com.br

Hospital das Clínicas da FMUSP
São Paulo, Brazil

Specialty: Leukemia

Collaborating Professor in the Discipline of Hematology and Hemotherapy at FMUSP. Assistant Physician at the Cancer Institute of the Hospital das Clínicas, FMUSP. He holds a PhD in Medical Sciences/Hematology from the University of São Paulo Medical School (2022). Associate member of the American Society of Hematology. Faculty member of the Clinical Research Training Institute Latin America of the American Society of Hematology. Responsible for evaluating Hematology projects at the ICESP Research Center. Investigator and sub-investigator in various international clinical trials in the field. Member of the research group at the Medical Investigation Laboratory for Pathogenesis and Targeted Therapy in Onco-Immuno-Hematology (LIM-31), where he conducts collaborative research on Acute Leukemias. Institutional representative in the International Consortium for Acute Leukemias (ICAL), a Latin American registry for acute myeloid leukemias. Founding member of the BRALLA group (Brazilian protocol for adult ALL treatment). His research is focused on implementing prospective clinical and translational research on Acute Leukemias in Latin America. Reviewer of several indexed journals.

Adrian Soto-Mota
MD, PhD
adrian.sotom@incmnsz.mx

Mexico's National Institute of Medical Sciences and Nutrition
Ciudad de Mexico, Tlalpan, México

Specialty: Biostatistician

I obtained my MD in Mexico and specialized as an internist at Mexico's National Institute of Medical Sciences and Nutrition. Afterward, I trained as a Data scientist at Harvard and obtained my PhD in Physiology at Oxford. My research has focused on the clinical applications and prescription of dietary interventions. However, most of my collaborations involve advanced Statistical Analysis and Clinical Prediction Tools. I am a tax-funded clinical researcher and Internal Medicine consultant at Mexico's National Institute of Medical Sciences and Nutrition, where I also lead the Metabolic Diseases Research Unit. I was recognized as a Fellow of the American College of Physicians in 2024 and received the Peter J Reeds Early Career Researcher Award from the American Society of Nutrition in 2025.

Elizabeth Uleryk
MLS
emulerykconsulting@gmail.com

E.M. Uleryk Consulting
Mississauga, ON, Canada

Specialty: Librarian

Elizabeth Uleryk is the principal of E.M. Uleryk Consulting specializing in evidence-based health sciences literature searching and teaching. A graduate of McGill University she has worked in both university medical school and hospital libraries. She specializes in developing and running Guideline and Systematic review search strategies in a variety of subject areas. She teaches evidence-based searching and EndNote classes in the graduate program of the Department of Health Policy, Management and Evaluation, University of Toronto. During her career, she has developed and run searches for Cochrane Systematic Reviews, scoping reviews, systematic reviews in primary journals, clinical practice guidelines, and student dissertations/thesis work.

Sara Vesely
PhD
sara-vesely@ouhsc.edu

University of Oklahoma Health Sciences Center
Oklahoma City, OK, USA

Specialty: Biostatistician

Dr. Vesely is a David Ross Boyd Professor of Biostatistics at the University of Oklahoma Health Sciences Center, Associate Dean of Academic Affairs in the Hudson College of Public Health, and the director of the Biostatistics and Research Design Shared Resource at the Stephenson Cancer Center. She is a biostatistician with experience in systematic reviews, guideline development, clinical trials, and evidence-based medicine. Throughout her career, a major part of her research has focused on clinical problems in hematology. She has been part of the faculty at the weeklong American Society of Hematology (ASH) Clinical Research Training Institute (CRTI) workshop for over ten years and is a member of the ASH CRTI Steering Subcommittee that oversees the program. Dr. Vesely is currently serving as a co-director of CRTI– LA (Latin America). Dr. Vesely has been a member of the faculty at OUHSC since 1999; she has taught over 50 courses and served as a mentor for over 65 graduate students. She has published over 200 peer-reviewed publications.

JUNIOR FACULTY

Gustavo Barroso Sánchez
MD, PhD
gustavohem92@gmail.com

Instituto de Hematología e Inmunología
Havana, Cuba

Interests: Anemia | Leukemia | Pediatric Hematology/Oncology | Sickle Cell Disease

Dr. Gustavo Barroso Sánchez is a clinical hematologist and early-career investigator with a PhD in Medical Sciences, serving as a Senior Professor of Pediatric and Molecular Hematology at the Institute of Hematology and Immunology in Havana, Cuba. He integrates clinical practice with translational research focused on improving outcomes for patients with hematologic malignancies in resource-limited settings. His work includes observational studies, cytogenomic characterization, and implementation of omics technologies. His career goal is to become a leading clinical researcher in Latin America, by the integration of precision medicine, translational hematology, and implementation science to develop personalized treatment protocols and improve therapeutic outcomes for patients with hematologic neoplasms in Latin America. Through the ASH Advanced CRTI-LA program, he aims to strengthen his expertise in these areas to design and lead fundable, context-adapted clinical research initiatives that optimize diagnostics, treatment access, and clinical results for pediatric and adult hematology patients across the region.

Estefania Rossetti
MD
estefania.rossetti86@gmail.com

Hospital de Pediatría Dr. Juan P. Garrahan
Buenos Aires, Argentina

Interests: Anemia | Aplastic Anemia/Bone Marrow Failure | Autoimmune Disorders | Sickle Cell Disease

Dr. Rossetti is a consultant in the Department of Pediatric Hematology at Hospital de Pediatría Dr. Juan P. Garrahan. She is actively involved in the care of both inpatient and outpatient children with hemoglobinopathies, red cell membrane disorders, immune cytopenias, and bone marrow failure syndromes. She holds a degree in Education and currently serves as Co-Director of the Advanced Fellowship Training Program in Hemoglobinopathies. Dr. Rossetti has recently completed a Master's degree in Molecular Biology. Her thesis focused on an extensive genotype–phenotype correlation study of β-thalassemia in Argentina. Her career goal is to engage in multicenter clinical research collaborations across the Americas, with the aim of advancing knowledge of hematologic diseases and expanding therapeutic opportunities for affected patients.

Participant Roster: CRTI-LA

Yoneka Ali
MEd
yonekasamanthaaliflores@gmail.com

Sociedad Boliviana de Hemarología
Bloivia

Interests: Multiple Myeloma

Dr. Yoneka Samantha Ali Flores is a clinical hematologist from La Paz, Bolivia, currently completing an advanced fellowship in Monoclonal Gammopathies and Multiple Myeloma at Instituto Nacional de Ciencias Médicas y Nutrición Salvador Zubirán. She earned her medical degree from Universidad Mayor de San Andrés and completed her specialty training in Hematology and Hemotherapy at Caja Nacional de Salud, Bolivia. She has served as an attending hematologist at Hospital de Clínicas and Caja Nacional de Salud in La Paz and as a faculty instructor in hematology residency programs. Dr. Ali Flores has been actively involved in the national hematology community as a board member of the Sociedad Paceña de Hematología y Hemoterapia and as Bolivia's representative to the Grupo Cooperativo Latinoamericano de Hemostasia y Trombosis (CLAHT). She also completed an international rotation in hematopoietic stem cell transplantation at Universidade Federal de São Paulo. Her long-term goal is to become an independent clinician-investigator focused on improving diagnosis, risk stratification, and treatment of multiple myeloma and other monoclonal gammopathies through multicenter clinical research in re

Elia Apodaca Chavez
MD, MSc
eliapanda08@gmail.com

Instituto Nacional de Ciencias Médicas y Nutrición Salvador Zubirán
México

Interests: Aplastic Anemia/Bone Marrow Failure |Leukemia | Myelodysplastic Syndromes

My name is Dr. Elia Apodaca, and I am a hematologist working in the Bone Marrow Failure Clinic at the National Institute of Medical Sciences and Nutrition in Mexico. A central component of my daily clinical practice is conducting research in patients with myelodysplastic syndromes (MDS), aplastic anemia, and paroxysmal nocturnal hemoglobinuria (PNH). In Mexico, there is limited epidemiologic and molecular data regarding these conditions. Therefore, my research focuses on characterizing our national patient population and comparing outcomes and disease behavior with international cohorts. My current research protocol aims to define the molecular landscape of patients with MDS and evaluate whether the IPSS-M performs similarly in the Mexican population. This will allow us to identify the most prevalent molecular alterations and assess their prognostic impact in our setting. By participating in the CRTI program, I seek to strengthen my research methodology skills and develop robust investigative tools that will improve the quality and impact of studies conducted in patients with bone marrow failure syndromes in Mexico. Thank you for the opportunity.

Marília Catto
MD
marilia.catto@hemocentro.fmrp.usp.br

University of São Paulo
Ribeirão Preto, São Paulo, Brazil

Interests: Aplastic Anemia/Bone Marrow Failure | Myelodysplastic Syndromes

Dr. Marília Bazzo Catto is a clinical hematologist and early-career investigator in Brazil, currently working at the Ribeirão Preto Blood Center and pursuing a PhD in Clinical Oncology, Hematology, and Cell Therapy at the University of São Paulo. She combines clinical practice and research, with a focus on improving outcomes for patients with bone marrow failure syndromes and myeloid diseases. Her research interests include bone marrow failures, MDS/AML and clonal hematopoiesis. Her current project investigates how somatic mutations influence treatment response and long-term outcomes in immune aplastic anemia, with the goal of refining risk stratification and supporting more individualized therapeutic decisions. Dr. Catto is in the process of consolidating her academic research career through doctoral training and collaborative projects in hematology. Her career development goal for the program is to become an independent clinician-scientist capable of leading multicenter clinical research in Latin America. Through the ASH CRTI-LA program, she aims to strengthen her skills in clinical study design, biostatistics, and collaborative research development.

Daniela Chacón
MD
dchacon29@gmail.com

Banco Municipal de Sangre
Caracas, Distrito Capital, Venezuela

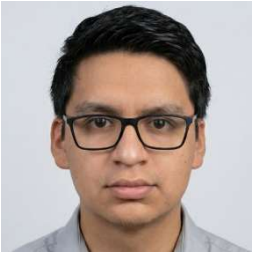
Interests: Leukemia | Lymphoma | Multiple Myeloma | Myeloproliferative Disorders

During my hematology residency, I developed a special interest in malignant diseases. Since graduating as a hematologist in 2023, I have been part of the hematology-oncology service team, with a particular focus on the care of patients with acute leukemias and lymphomas, the development of treatment protocols, and the formation of teams for the guidance and management of patients with these conditions. I am also an assistant professor in the hematology residency program accredited by the Central University of Venezuela at the Municipal Blood Bank Hospital. My main research focus is the management of indolent and aggressive lymphomas and acute leukemias in populations with limited resources for diagnosis and treatment, such as those in our country. My goal as part of my team is to resume the research component, develop clinical trials, and establish new diagnostic and management protocols focused on our patients. ASH CRTI-LA program course is a great and unique opportunity to acquire tools and skills for improving the development of research lines in lymphomas and leukemias.

Bryan Chuquimarca
MD
bryanchuquimarcac@gmail.com

Hospital de Clínicas
Montevideo, Uruguay

Interests: Anemia | Leukemia | Sickle Cell Disease | Thrombosis and Hemostasis/Blood Clotting



Bryan Chuquimarca, MD, is a clinical hematologist and early-career researcher based in Uruguay. He is currently pursuing advanced postgraduate training in Hematology as well as a Master's degree in Clinical Research, with academic affiliation at the Universidad de la República. Dr. Chuquimarca integrates full-time clinical practice with patient-oriented clinical research, specifically focused on improving outcomes for patients with hemoglobinopathies. Dr. Chuquimarca's research program centers on hemoglobinopathies, with an emphasis on molecular diagnostics and expanding access to specialized treatments within the Latin American landscape. His work encompasses prospective observational studies, and he has successfully secured competitive funding from the University to support his research on clinical outcomes. His long-term career objective is to become an independent physician-scientist leading multicenter clinical research collaborations in hematology across Latin America. Through his participation in the ASH CRTI-LA program, Dr. Chuquimarca aims to develop a fundable, multicenter molecular diagnostic protocol designed to enhance diagnostic precision in hemoglobinopathies.

Victor Hugo Diaz Silva
MD
vhdiazs@hotmail.com

Hospital Regional Lambayeque
Chiclayo, Peru

Interests: Anemia | Autoimmune Disorders | Low Platelet Counts | Pediatric Hematology/Oncology

Dr. Víctor Díaz is a clinical hematologist with specialization studies in pediatrics and some experience in advising medical student theses in the city of Chiclayo - Perú and with affiliation to the Lambayeque Regional Hospital. Dr. Víctor Díaz's research interests include anemia and immune thrombocytopenia in the pediatric population. His research is based on observational studies and systematic reviews. This research has been sponsored by universities as part of their students' academic training. Dr. Víctor Díaz's career goal is to establish a research center focused on benign hematological pathologies in the pediatric population, enabling clinical trials and the generation of solid evidence to optimize evidence-based medical care for benign hematological diseases in children under 18 years of age.

João dos Santos
MD, PhD
jconrado49@gmail.com

Universidade de Sao Paulo
São Paulo, São Paulo, Brazil

Interests: Anemia | Leukemia | Sickle Cell Disease

Joao Conrado obtained his Medical degree in 2019 and completed a PhD in 2022 through the Physician-Scientist Program at the University of Campinas. He subsequently completed residency training in Internal Medicine and in Hematology at Hospital das Clínicas at the University of São Paulo in 2025. He served as a Hematology Residency Preceptor at the same institution, combining clinical care with academic mentorship. His current research focuses on Sickle Cell Disease, germline mutations in rare hematologic disorders, and outcomes analysis in patients with acute leukemias. He is particularly interested in integrating molecular and clinical data to improve risk stratification, refine therapeutic strategies, and promote evidence-based, patient-centered care. His long-term career goal is to establish himself as a physician-scientist dedicated to advancing clinical and translational research in Hematology. He aims to bridge scientific discovery and clinical practice while addressing disparities in access, diagnosis, and outcomes in hematologic diseases. Participation in CRTI-LA represents a strategic step toward this objective, as it will provide advanced methodological training

Virginia Fux
MD
virginiafux@gmail.com

Hospital Garrahan
Buenos Aires, Argentina

Interests: Leukemia | Lymphoma | Pediatric Hematology/Oncology

Dr. Virginia Fux is a Pediatrician and a third-year Pediatric Hematology and Oncology fellow at the Hospital de Pediatría Prof. Dr. Juan P. Garrahan in Buenos Aires, Argentina, where she also completed her pediatric residency. She is a member of the Argentine Society of Pediatrics (SAP) and has presented several clinical cases at national congresses and scientific meetings within Argentina. Her primary research interests are focused on pediatric leukemias and lymphomas. Dr. Fux believes that clinical research is a fundamental complement to medical practice, and she seeks to acquire additional tools in this area to enhance and complement her professional development and daily clinical work. Through the ASH CRTI-LA program, Dr. Fux aims to expand her knowledge of clinical research methodology and statistical analysis. Her goal is to gain the skills needed to develop structured research projects and participate in multicenter clinical protocols. She aspires to foster regional collaborations in Latin America to help ensure that pediatric patients across the region have access to standardized and high-quality treatment supported by cutting-edge research.

Xitlaly Judith Gonzalez Leal
MD
xitlaly.gonzalez@tec.mx

Tec de Monterrey
Monterrey, Nuevo León, México

Interests: Bone Marrow/Stem Cell Transplantation | Leukemia | Lymphoma | Multiple Myeloma

Dr. Xitlaly Gonzalez is a clinical hematologist based in Monterrey, Mexico, with a private practice focused on hematology and hematopoietic stem cell transplantation. She also serves as a faculty member at the School of Medicine at Tecnológico de Monterrey, Campus Monterrey, where she is involved in the academic training of medical students. Dr. Gonzalez integrates clinical care with academic activity and has presented her work at both national and international conferences. Her research interests center on hematopoietic stem cell transplantation and patient-reported outcomes, with a particular focus on understanding the lived experiences of patients undergoing complex hematologic treatments. She is committed to developing a research career aimed at identifying areas for improvement in patient-centered care and optimizing transplant outcomes. Through the CRTI-LA program, Dr. Gonzalez seeks to strengthen her research methodology skills and build collaborative networks that will allow her to design impactful clinical studies. She is particularly motivated to apply the knowledge gained to her institution and to mentor young physicians interested in clinical research.

Rafael Loachamín Huertas
MD
rafael.loachamin@hee.gob.ec

Hospital De Especialidades Eugenio Espejo
Quito, Ecuador

Interests: Bone Marrow/Stem Cell Transplantation | Leukemia | Lymphoma | Multiple Myeloma

Dr. Rafael Loachamín is an internist and hematologist who graduated from Hospital das Clínicas in Brazil, with a specialization in stem cell transplantation. He began his investigation career during a Master's program in Medical Research at the International University of Ecuador, where he received a grant to support his studies and is part of the study group on Social Environmental Determinants of Health Inequalities (SEDHI). Currently, Dr. Rafael Loachamín is an assistant physician at Eugenio Espejo Hospital in Quito, Ecuador, and at Hospital Vozandes Quito, focusing on patients with onco-hematology diseases. He has also started a stem cell transplantation program supported by the Ministry of Health of Ecuador. Dr. Rafael Loachamín has initiated research using the cancer population registry, focusing on lymphomas, and actively participates in the hospital registry supported by the country's Hematology Scientific Society. The goal is to obtain a situational diagnosis of onco-hematology diseases and contribute proposals to improve survival rates for these diseases in the country.

David Orccosupa Quispe
MD
bresukite@gmail.com

Hospital Nacional Edgardo Rebagliati Martins
Lima, Perú

Interests: Leukemia | Lymphoma | Multiple Myeloma | Myelodysplastic Syndromes

Dr. David Jonathan Orccosupa Quispe is a hematology resident at the Hospital Nacional Edgardo Rebagliati Martins in Lima, Peru. He combines full-time clinical training with clinical research focused on hematologic malignancies in resource-limited health care settings in Latin America. His research interests include multiple myeloma, acute leukemias, and lymphoma, with a particular focus on real-world outcomes, treatment-related toxicities, and access to modern therapies in middle-income countries. His current work includes retrospective clinical studies evaluating outcomes of patients with multiple myeloma treated with bortezomib-based regimens and research on complications associated with hematologic malignancies and their treatment. Dr. Orccosupa's career goal is to become a clinician-scientist dedicated to developing collaborative multicenter research in hematology across Latin America, with the aim of improving access to evidence-based treatments and patient outcomes in the region. Through participation in the ASH Clinical Research Training Institute in Latin America (CRTI-LA), he hopes to strengthen his research skills and develop multicenter clinical research projects focus

Aline Paats
MD
alinepaatsn@gmail.com

Hospital Central del IPS
Asunción, Paraguay

Interests: Bone Marrow/Stem Cell Transplantation | Lymphoma | Multiple Myeloma

Dra. Aline Paats is a clinical hematologist and early-career investigator based in Paraguay, serving as Coordinator of Paraguayan Marrow Donor Registry and phyisican at the Bone Marrow Transplant unit in Hospital Central del Instituto de Previsión Social. She also works at the Myeloma and Lymphoma outpatient clinic. Dra. Aline Paats research focus on transplant in the limit resource setting, addressing limitations in access to essencial drugs and other health care disparities. Dra. Aline Paats's career goal is to draw attention to the need of her region and attract interest from the industry and improve access to clnical trials.

Luiza Lapolla Perruso
MD
luiza.lapolla@gmail.com

Idor-SP / USP-SP
São Paulo

Interests: Leukemia | Lymphoma | Multiple Myeloma | Myelodysplastic Syndromes

Dr. Luiza Lapolla Perruso is a hematologist, clinical researcher, and preceptor in the hematology residency program. She trained at the Hospital das Clínicas of the University of São Paulo (USP-SP) and currently focuses on acute leukemias, the subject of her PhD project at the same institution. She works with clinical trials and registry studies and is responsible for the Brazilian Acute Myeloid Leukemia Registry. Her research explores socioeconomic influences on clinical outcomes in acute leukemia; two of her studies were presented at recent ASH meetings and received Abstract Achievement Awards. Dr. Lapolla treats AML patients in both public and private settings and seeks to better understand regional population characteristics to adapt treatment strategies and improve outcomes. She aims to become an independent clinician-scientist leading multicenter hematology research collaborations across Latin America and to develop clinical trials focused on improving outcomes in acute leukemia.

Alfredo Pinedo Rodríguez
MD
alfredo2895@gmai.com

Instituto Nacional de Ciencias Médicas y Nutrición Salvador Zubirán
México

Interests: Autoimmune Disorders | Low Platelet Counts | Thrombosis and Hemostasis/Blood Clotting | Transfusion Medicine

Dr. Alfredo Pinedo is an internist and currently a third-year Hematology resident at the Instituto Nacional de Ciencias Médicas y Nutrición Salvador Zubirán in Mexico City. His work primarily involves clinical care and teaching activities; however, he is also interested in developing a stronger focus on research. His main areas of interest include classical hematology, particularly immune cytopenias, non-immune hemolytic anemias, iron disorders, transfusion medicine, and hemostasis and thrombosis. His primary goal is to conduct research in classical hematologic disorders, an area that represents an important opportunity for development in Mexico. For this reason, participating in the ASH CRTI-LA program would represent a valuable opportunity to advance his research training and contribute to this field.

Luis Fernando Rivas
MD
luis_fernando_100@hotmail.com

Instituto Salvadoreño del Seguro Social
El Salvador

Interests: Anemia | Bleeding Disorders | Lymphoma | Myeloproliferative Disorders

Dr. Luis Rivas is a clinical hematologist based in El Salvador and serves as Head of the Hematology Department. He combines full-time clinical practice with academic leadership and research mentorship, while also serving as a Professor of Research, training the next generation of physicians in clinical investigation. Dr. Rivas is an active member of PBM El Salvador and has participated in international academic forums, including the Annual Meeting of the American Society of Hematology. Dr. Rivas' academic interests focus on multiple myeloma, plasma cell disorders, flow cytometry, and the integration of genomic tools into clinical hematology. His work emphasizes real-world data generation, optimization of diagnostic strategies, and implementation of evidence-based approaches in resource-constrained healthcare systems. He has delivered national lectures in cytogenetics and genomics and actively promotes the incorporation of advanced diagnostic platforms into routine hematologic practice in El Salvador. As a department leader, Dr. Rivas is committed to strengthening clinical research infrastructure and fostering collaborative networks across Central America.

Macarena Roa
MD
macarenaroa.md@gmail.com

Hospital del Salvador
Metropolitana

Interests: Bone Marrow\Stem Cell Transplantation | Leukemia | Lymphoma | Transfusion Medicine

Dr. Macarena Roa is a hematologist based in Santiago, Chile, working in the public and private health system. Her research interests include acute myeloid leukemia, lymphoid malignancies, and EBV-associated diseases, with a focus on cytogenetic and molecular risk stratification and disparities in access to specialized diagnostics in Latin America. She participates in national multicenter cohort studies aimed at describing real-world outcomes in leukemia and lymphoma. She has received institutional and collaborative support for the development of national leukemia and lymphoma registries and has contributed to research presented at international scientific meetings. Through the CRTI program, she aims to strengthen her training in research and develop collaborative projects that improve diagnosis, access to care, and outcomes for patients with hematologic malignancies.

Haydeé Salazar Rosales
MD
ennuye@hotmail.com

National Institute of Pediatrics
Mexico City, Mexico

Interests: Bone Marrow/Stem Cell Transplantation | Leukemia | Lymphoma | Pediatric Hematology/Oncology

Dr. Haydee Salazar is a clinical oncologist pediatrician, serving as a physician and professor of Stem Cell Transplantation Unit at National Institute of Pediatrics in Mexico City with academic afiliation at Universidad Nacional Autonoma de Mexico. Observing that clinical research can provide early interventions to improve patient prognoses or even provide new therapeutic opportunities for patients with unfavorable outcomes has inspired me to pursue a career in research. During my training in hematopoietic progenitor cell transplantation field, I have gained the closest connection to research, including clinical trials of patients diagnosed with acute lymphoblastic leukemia or chronic granulocytic leukemia for the administration of drugs such as carfilzomib and ponatinib in the pediatric population. The objective of applying for this fellowship is to develop solid competencies in translational or personalized research with a high academic level, so that in the future I can combine clinical practice with routine research and contribute to the development, with my team, of more effective and accessible treatment strategies for Mexican or Latin American patients.

Abdullah Salehji B.
MD, DM
abdullahsalehji302@gmail.com

Caja de Seguro Social
Panamá

Interests: Leukemia | Multiple Myeloma | Myeloproliferative Disorders

Dr. Abdullah Salehji is a hematology resident at Caja de Seguro Social in Panama. His clinical and research interests focus on hematologic malignancies, particularly aggressive lymphomas and acute leukemias, with an emphasis on real-world outcomes and the challenges of delivering modern therapies in resource-constrained health care systems. Dr. Salehji is actively involved in clinical research using institutional cohorts from one of Panama's largest referral centers. His work includes observational studies evaluating outcomes in diffuse large B-cell lymphoma, as well as projects exploring epidemiologic patterns, treatment accessibility, and clinical outcomes in the Panamanian population. Through his research activities, Dr. Salehji aims to contribute to a better understanding of hematologic cancers in Latin America and to generate locally relevant data that can inform clinical practice in settings with limited resources. His long-term goal is to promote and expand clinical research in hematology in Panama, fostering collaborative projects that leverage the unique opportunities within the region to improve patient care and advance scientific knowledge in hematology.

Lais Silva | Clínica AMO
MD | Brazil
laissilva.ext@dasa.com.br | **Interests**: Myeloid Malignancies (including myeloproliferative disorders)

Beatriz Wills | Fundacion Santa Fe De Bogota
MD | Bogota
beatriz.wills@fsfb.org.co | **Interests**: Lymphoma | Multiple Myeloma

Dr. Wills is a clinical hematologist–oncologist based in Bogotá. She serves as Assistant Attending at Fundación Santa Fe de Bogotá, Assistant Professor at Universidad de los Andes, and collaborates with the Instituto Nacional de Cancerología. Her research interests include hematologic malignancies, cellular therapy, and cancer disparities, with particular emphasis on implementing CAR-T cell therapy for lymphoma and multiple myeloma in resource-limited settings. Her work integrates decentralized manufacturing strategies, regulatory engagement, and multidisciplinary clinical care to enable sustainable delivery of cellular therapies. Dr. Wills is Principal Investigator of Colombia's first investigator-initiated anti-CD19 CAR-T cell therapy program. She has received the American Society of Hematology Global Research Award and prior funding through the Robert Winn Diversity in Clinical Trials Program. Her career goal is to become an independent clinician-scientist leading multicenter, equity-focused clinical trials that expand access to advanced cancer therapies and increase inclusion of underrepresented populations in research.

CRTI-LA Small Group Roster

GROUP 1

Small Group Leader: Kara Kelly
Faculty: Roberta Demichelis | Lucia Perez Baliero
Biostatistician: Lucas Bassolli

Participants	
João Dos Santos	Evaluation of Prophylaxis and Therapy for Carbapenemase-Producing Enterobacteriaceae Infections in Patients with Acute Leukemia
Virginia Fux	Prognostic Impact of Extramedullary Disease at Diagnosis in Pediatric Acute Myeloid Leukemia with RUNX1::RUNX1T1: A 35-Year Single-Center Cohort Study in Argentina
Macarena Roa	Mapping Geographic Hotspots of Acute Myeloid Leukemia and Their Association With Adverse Cytomolecular Features and Environmental Factors
Lais Silva	Improving Referral Pathways for Suspected Acute Leukemia Using Artificial Intelligence in the Brazilian Public Health System

GROUP 2

Small Group Leader: Andrés Gómez De León
Faculty: Wellington Silva | Melina Garbarini
Biostatistician: Susan Geyer

Participants	
Elia Apodaca Chavez	Molecular Characterization of Myelodysplastic Syndrome in the Mexican Population
Daniela Chacón	Treatment-free remission in patients with chronic myeloid leukemia from the hematooncology service of the Banco Municipal de Sangre
Luiza Perruso	Venetoclax-Azacitidine vs chemo: Leukemia Outcomes and Resource utilization in a brazilian public center (VALOR study)
Luis Rivas	Epidemiological profile of patients with chronic myeloid leukemia

GROUP 3

Small Group Leader: Eloisa Riva
Faculty: Humberto Martinez | Natalia Schütz
Biostatistician: Adrian Soto

Participants	
Yoneka Ali	Perfil citogenético de pacientes con mieloma múltiple en Bolivia: estudio de correlación clínica y análisis de factibilidad diagnóstica
David Orccosupa Quispe	Association between seru 25(OH)D levels and bortezomib, thalidomide, and dexamethasone–induced peripheral neuropathy in patients with multiple myeloma
Aline Paats	Validation of the EASIX score in a Latinamerican cohort
Beatriz Wills	A Feasibility Study: Implementing Place-of-Care Manufacturing and Local Delivery of BCMA CAR T-cell Therapy for Patients with Relapsed/Refractory Multiple Myeloma in Colombia

GROUP 4

Small Group Leader: Fernanda Orsi
Faculty: Cece Calhoun | Jane Hankins
Biostatistician: Eliana Miranda

Participants	
Marília Catto	The impact of somatic variants on the clinical outcome of patients with Immune Aplastic Anemia
Bryan Chuquimarca	Bridging the Gap: Epidemiological and Molecular Characterization of hemoglobinopathies in Uruguay Using PCR and Sanger Sequencing
Victor Diaz Silva	the long-term safety and efficacy of treatment with thrombopoietin analogues in patients under 18 years of age who suffer from chronic immune thrombocytopenia
Alfredo Pinedo Rodríguez	Upfront corticosteroid and inmunosuppressor therapy (excluding rituximab) versus corticosteroid monotherapy in newly diagnosed warm autoimmune hemolytic anemia

GROUP 5

Small Group Leader: Allison King
Faculty: Cristobal Frutos | Robert Negrin
Biostatistician: Sara Vesely

Participants	
Xitlaly Gonzalez Leal	Quality of Life Comparison in Patients and Caregivers Undergoing Inpatient versus Outpatient Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation
Rafael Loachamin Huertas	"What are the socioeconomic and clinical factors that influence overall survival among patients with lymphoma treated in Quito, Ecuador, and how do disparities in education level, type of healthcare facility, and occupation affect clinical outcomes?"
Haydeé Salazar Rosales	Impact of chimerism level on the efficacy of donor lymphocyte infusion in patients with hematological malignancies
Abdullah Salehji	Two Decades of Burkitt Lymphoma in a Panamanian Referral Center: Epidemiology, Clinical Patterns, and Outcomes in a Resource-Limited Setting

Conflict of Interest Disclosures

The American Society of Hematology (ASH) is dedicated to advancing the specialty of hematology. To accomplish this mission, ASH provides support for a variety of activities in the areas of research, education, training, and advocacy. The integrity of ASH and the activities it undertakes depends on the avoidance of conflicts of interest, or even the appearance of conflicts, by the individuals involved with those activities. The intent of these disclosures is not to prevent a speaker with a relevant financial or other relationship from making a presentation, but rather to provide the audience with information on which they can make their own judgements. It remains for the audience to determine whether the speaker's interest or relationships may influence the presentation with regard to exposition or conclusion.

If bias, actual or perceived, occurs during a presentation, program attendees are encouraged to address such bias, as well as bias resulting from conflicts that speakers have not disclosed, during the question-and-answer period following the presentation.

Code of Conduct

As you know, ASH has a formal code of conduct for all its volunteers. Each of us has signed and acknowledged the ASH Volunteer Code of Conduct and is therefore expected to demonstrate the highest standards of professionalism, always conducting ourselves in a collegial and respectful manner, including during our deliberations today.

Implicit Bias

Implicit bias is inherent in all of us, in a variety of forms. Bias is not limited to race or gender, or age, and it doesn't make us bad people. However, these biases influence us in ways that aren't necessarily obvious. Research demonstrates that simply awareness and acknowledgement that implicit bias exists within us all, can mitigate the risks that these biases create.

With that in mind, we are asked to be mindful of our individual biases. It is important for our patients and our field that we innovate and accelerate. There is a wealth of research that demonstrates that having a broad variety of experiences and perspectives engaged in the research enterprise does just that.

Confidentiality Agreement

The American Society of Hematology (ASH) sponsors the Clinical Research Training Institute in Latin America (CRTI-LA) for the purpose of providing training, experience, and mentoring to promote the career development of its trainee participants ("Trainees"). The co-directors, faculty, and staff of the CRTI-LA (who, collectively with the Trainees, will be referred to as the "Participants") work to create and maintain an environment that is conducive and welcoming of open discussions within the CRTI-LA. From time to time, such discussions may involve research ideas, data, plans, unpublished hypotheses, research results, and other information that is not otherwise available to the public and is being disclosed by a CRTI-LA Participant for discussion purposes within the CRTI-LA solely to further the training and development objectives of the CRTI-LA (collectively "Confidential Information"). This Agreement sets forth the obligations of all CRTI-LA Participants with respect to Confidential Information disclosed within the course of the CRTI-LA.

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With respect to any information and materials identified as Confidential Information by a Disclosing Participant during the course of the CRTI-LA, each CRTI-LA Participant agrees that he or she shall: (a) not disclose any such Confidential Information to anyone other than current CRTI-LA Participants, and then only for discussion purposes within the current CRTI-LA; (b) use such Confidential Information solely for discussion purposes within the current CRTI-

LA and not for any other purpose; and (c) use all reasonable means to protect the confidentiality of such information. Nothing in this Agreement is intended to prohibit disclosure of Confidential Information: (a) pursuant to a valid court order requiring such disclosure, provided that the recipient of the order informs the Disclosing Participant immediately of the existence of the order; or (b) with the prior written consent of the Disclosing Participant. By executing this Agreement, each CRTI-LA Participant represents and warrants that he or she understands that civil and criminal penalties may apply to the wrongful use or misappropriation of Confidential Information in violation of the common law, applicable statutes, or the contractual or intellectual property rights of others.

All CRTI-LA Participants must certify that they are aware of this policy and that they will abide by it. If, for any reason, an individual is unable to enter into this Agreement, he or she must notify the CRTI-LA co-directors and staff immediately.

I certify that I have read and agree to comply with this Confidentiality and Non-Disclosure Agreement. I also understand that this Agreement becomes effective upon my execution of the Agreement and continues in effect with respect to any Confidential Information disclosed during the CRTI-LA until that information becomes publicly available through lawful means and no longer qualifies as Confidential Information. In addition to potential civil and criminal penalties for misuse or misappropriation of Confidential Information, failure to comply with the terms and spirit of this Agreement could result in my dismissal from the remainder of the CRTI-LA program and its activities and disclosure of the circumstances of my violation of this Agreement to my employer, Program Director, and/or Department Chairperson.

ASH Opportunities

ASH GLOBAL RESEARCH AWARD

- **What:** Fund future international scientific leaders in hematology
- **Who:** MD, PhD or MD-PhD (or equivalent)
- **When:** Obtained degree no more than 16 years prior to application
- **How Much:**
  - $100,000 for projects six months up to 1 year
  - $150,000 for projects up to 2 years

EXPLORER PATHWAY PROGRAM

- **What:** Year-long career development program for individuals to submit competitive proposals
- **Who:** MD, PhD or MD-PhD (or equivalent) in Low to Middle Income Countries
- **When:** Obtained degree no more than 16 years prior to application
- **How Much:** $20,000

VISITOR TRAINING PROGRAM (VTP)

- **What:** 12 weeks of training for clinical, laboratory, or technical experience with an ASH member mentor anywhere in world
- **Who:** Hematologists and hematology-related health care professionals working in a hospital, clinic, or laboratory in Low to Middle Income Countries
- **How Much:** Covers visa fees, round-trip airfare, accommodations, and daily living expenses

BLOOD GLOBAL HEMATOLOGY

- **Global Expert Editors & Reviewers:** Editors & reviewers span full breadth of hematologic research & geographic regions.
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